



IS A GLOBAL ALLIANCE AGAINST TERRORISM POSSIBLE?

“We must have a new world order to fight terror”

DOMINIQUE DE VILLEPIN FORMER PRIME MINISTER OF FRANCE

We are now at a crucial moment. It's a turning point in history. Last year has shown that the balance of powers is shifting. Emerging countries are claiming bigger roles in the world. And I strongly believe India will be a central actor in the new world order. It has a responsibility within the subcontinent, where challenges and conflicts are numerous. It also has a greater role to play in the international scene, in becoming a member of an enlarged G-8 and as a permanent member of the UN Security Council.

The economic crisis is turning the hierarchies of the world's economy upside down. It's a challenge for all of us to enhance global regulation. But the solution won't come without the contribution of Asian economies. Barack Obama has brought new hope to the world. After eight years of unilateral policy, based on power, America is opening up to the world. A time of dialogue seems to be beginning; it's an opportunity to seize.

How can we be effective in our fight against global terrorism and help each other? I believe that terrorism calls for a powerful mobilisation of all states. In this case, what kind of action should we wage? Is a global alliance against terrorism the solution? First, international cooperation is needed to investigate and dismantle terrorist movements and networks. Those who want to attack us are a few hundred individuals scattered around the globe. And yet they have turned their mobility into a fearful weapon against the world.

Second, terrorism is the product of a strategy built on three pillars—first, the show of force, measured in the number of deaths and shock value; second, media impact, which leads terrorists to strike a distant but symbolic target so as to gain legitimacy; third, jihad drawing its inspiration from extremist Islam.

Terrorist groups have global aims, planetary networks and techniques of mobility and



“WE NEED TO AVOID THE TRAP OF FORMING A MILITARY ALLIANCE TO WAGE A MERCILESS WAR.”

DOMINIQUE DE VILLEPIN

dissemination that transcend national borders. Terrorism has its own territorial organisation, recruitment zones and battlegrounds.

This threat can only be addressed by strong cooperation of victim countries. First, the states must intensify the legal cooperation of their police forces and judicial systems. Today's procedures are too rigid and formal. They are often too slow. Direct collaboration and legislative harmonisation are the keys to success.